17.6 Malnutrition in Children*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says, "She eats very little." **Objective** • Weight-for-height below −3 SD • Visible wasting • Low mid-upper arm circumference	**ACTUAL** Inadequate protein energy nutritional intake related to insufficient dietary intake as evidenced by severe wasting and low mid-upper arm circumference.	• Steady weight gain in the rehabilitation phase.	• Follow the therapeutic feeding protocol, starting slowly. • Weigh daily. • Give micronutrients as prescribed. • Treat infection as ordered.	• Considered met as she gains weight.
Subjective • Mother says, "I did not know what to feed her." **Objective** • Diet mostly tea and bread • No meat or eggs	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge [parental] related to child nutrition as evidenced by an inadequate diet.	• Mother plans balanced meals.	• Teach which nutritious foods are available locally. • Teach small, frequent meals. • Arrange follow-up at the nutrition clinic.	• Goal reached when meals are planned.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Severe malnutrition • Temperature 36.0 °C	**RISK** Risk for decreased body temperature as evidenced by risk factors: inadequate body fat.	• Temperature kept at 36.5–37.5 °C.	• Keep her warm, covered and close to her mother. • Follow temperature. • Check blood glucose.	• Met when temperature is normal.

*References for this care plan: [35], [38], [119], [139]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.